tasks of the South Western Command and 9 Corps was completed. We also initiated the plans for force accretions to enhance our defensive capability by raising a Corps HQ with two infantry divisions and supporting arms and services for the east, and improvement of infrastructure, roads, railway, airports and capability building in the northeast. The air force has similarly upgraded its capability by improving the airfields and has inducted state-of-the-art aircraft in this theatre. These transformational steps have provided the much desired strategic balance to our posture in both the western and eastern theatres. Our endeavour has been not to allow 1962 to be repeated under any circumstances.

The consolidation of the new South Western Command and 9 Corps, and their capability to effectively carry out their operational responsibilities, was an operational KRA for us. During my tenure as the chief, a number of operational discussions, war games as also exercises with troops were conducted to validate our new doctrine for war fighting. A lot has appeared in media reports about the so-called ‘cold start strategy’ of the Indians. In our doctrine and military lexicon, there is no such term or strategy. However, the slow and cumbersome mobilization demonstrated during Operation Parakram has been replaced with procedures that imply a swift response and fighting ‘light and mean’. As a part of strategizing for various scenarios and contingencies, we have put into place, defined and practised specified courses of action which will be unravelled if and when we are challenged. I am confident that the Indian Army will successfully execute these plans.